REST and GraphQL API Engineering Guidelines

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API Versioning

All public endpoints must expose major version paths (e.g., /api/v2/orders). Breaking changes without 180 days advance deprecation notification are strictly forbidden.

Pagination & Throttling

Endpoints returning collections must enforce cursor-based pagination with a maximum default limit of 100 items. Default client rate limits are 1,200 requests per minute per authenticated client ID.

Payload & Schema Validation

All inbound payloads must be strictly validated against OpenAPI 3.1 schemas. Additional unmapped JSON fields must be rejected with HTTP 422 Unprocessable Content.

Idempotency

Mutating operations (POST/PATCH) handling financial transactions or inventory mutations must require an Idempotency-Key HTTP header valid for 24 hours.